

2.5 Architectural Primitives

3ds Max has a wealth of architectural primitives. These can be anything from doors and windows to staircases to foliage. Mostly these are used by architects, but they can also be used in animation for sets and backgrounds.

2.6 Using Modifiers

Once you've created your geometry, you can shape it further by using Modifiers. You'll find this under the Modifiers menu or in the Modifier List pull-down of the Modify panel. Modifiers can be used either on the entire object, or be restricted to parts of the object. They can also be combined by using the modifier stack to create more-complex shapes.

Parametric Deformers

Parametric deformers rely on user-defined parameters to change the shape of an object. This means you can change their values after they're applied and also animate them. Here are a few of the more commonly used deformers:

Bend: Bends the geometry around a user-definable axis

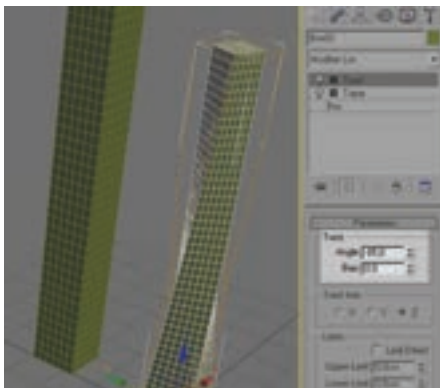
Taper: Tapers an object with a user-definable curvature

Twist: Applies a screw-like twist to the object

Skew: Skews the object in a user-defined direction

Relax: Softens the hard edges of an object

Spherify: Deforms the object to a spherical shape



The twist deformer

Adjusting Modifiers

Modifiers can be stacked in the Modify panel to create complex effects. Changes to one modifier will flow through the stack, giving you a wide degree of control over the modifications to an object. Modifiers can be rearranged simply by clicking and dragging. You can collapse all or part of the modifier stack. This locks in the changes and makes for a simpler object. Having a lot of modifiers on an object can take up a lot of system overhead, so collapsing the stack when an object is finished will make the scene update more quickly.